

Deficit recalculation and metabolic adaptation strategies guide — Action Checklist

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MEASURE YOUR BASELINE

- ☐ **Measure Baseline:** Weigh yourself every morning for seven consecutive days before eating or drinking anything to establish your true starting weight.
- ☐ **Measure Baseline:** Calculate your seven-day morning weight average by adding all seven readings and dividing by seven to remove daily fluctuations.
- ☐ **Measure Baseline:** Estimate your activity level honestly by considering whether you sit all day, walk regularly, or exercise multiple times weekly—the sedentary category includes desk jobs with minimal movement.
- ☐ **Measure Baseline:** Record your average weight, activity estimate, and calculated maintenance number in a dedicated tracking system so you can reference these numbers as you progress.

CALCULATE YOUR NUMBERS

- ☐ **Calculate Numbers:** Use the corrected maintenance formula by multiplying your average body weight in kilograms by 20 if you're female or 22 if you're male.
- ☐ **Calculate Numbers:** Add a 10% buffer to your base calculation by multiplying the result by 1.1 to account for overestimating activity and underestimating metabolic efficiency.
- ☐ **Calculate Numbers:** Determine your deficit floor by multiplying your maintenance estimate by 0.75 to find the calories representing a 25% deficit.
- ☐ **Calculate Numbers:** Determine your deficit ceiling by multiplying your maintenance estimate by 0.85 to find the calories representing a 15% deficit.

TRACK YOUR PROGRESS

- ☐ **Track Progress:** Target your daily calorie intake within the range between your deficit floor and ceiling rather than eating as little as possible.
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- **Track Progress:** Recognize that every 5 to 7 pounds of weight lost changes your energy requirements by roughly 30 to 50 calories requiring recalculation.

 - **Track Progress:** Plan to recalculate your maintenance numbers every 2 to 4 weeks by repeating morning weigh-ins and adjusting your target range accordingly.

 - **Track Progress:** Monitor the regain pattern by weighing yourself on Sunday evenings to catch the weekend weight recovery cycle before it compounds further.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.